

IBM's new System z Linux solutions

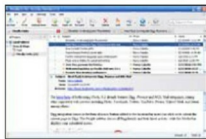
IBM has announced new Linux offerings for the System z mainframe which the company claims will help users run more efficient data centres that maximise the use of IT resources and reduce energy costs.

For clients currently running a distributed computing environment, IBM's new Enterprise Linux Server is a standalone system fully dedicated to running the Linux environment. With potential savings of up to 80 per cent, the new IBM Enterprise Linux Server provides attractive, off-the-shelf pricing with one of the industry's most powerful configurations for large-scale data centre consolidation on IBM System z. IBM is also offering a unique 'save-as-you-grow' pricing model, in which incremental capacity is priced significantly lower as the configuration size increases. For more information about System z, visit www.ibm.com/systems/z.



Thunderbird 3 showcases new search features

Mozilla has finally released Thunderbird 3 early in December offering more than 2,000 improvements over its previous version. Key new features in this release



include: tabbed e-mail that provides the ability to view individual emails and folders in tabs, and Web pages via add-ons in tabs; filtering and timeline tools in the new search interface to help users quickly and accurately pinpoint the exact email; the ability to archive mails which moves mails from the inbox into the new archive folder system; a one-click address book; a brand new account set-up wizard;

an add-ons manager; better integration with Gmail; and the Gecko 1.9.1 engine. Mozilla Thunderbird 3 is available for download at www.getthunderbird.com and for more information about Mozilla Thunderbird 3 visit www.mozillamessaging.com.

RH open sources SPICE

Red Hat, in an effort to openly collaborate with partners to drive the future of virtualisation, has open sourced its SPICE (Simple Protocol for Independent Computing Environment) hosted virtual desktop protocol. SPICE is a core component of the *Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation for Desktops* product that is currently in beta. SPICE is an adaptive remote rendering protocol designed specifically for virtual environments. With its modern, high-performance communications technology, SPICE aims to provide a seamless user experience for today's bandwidth-intensive applications such as multi-media and VoIP, offering a user experience comparable to that of a physical desktop. Through the Spice project, Red Hat will collaborate with its partners and the open source community to expand the development of the protocol in an effort to help break down barriers to virtualisation adoption. SPICE is one of three main technology components included in *Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation for Desktops*, a solution set currently in a private beta version with general availability expected in 2010.

Qt 4.6 enhances support for Symbian and Maemo

Qt 4.6 is now available featuring new platform support, powerful new graphical capabilities and support for multi-touch applications and gestures. The new version includes support for Symbian, and adds Windows 7, Apple Mac OS 10.6 and the upcoming Maemo 6 to the list of Qt-supported platforms. Also available is community support for real-time operating systems QNX and VxWorks. Support for Maemo 5 is currently in development. Being able to share code across platforms means that the applications you create could get to market faster and reach a broader audience of device users.

Qt 4.6 enhances graphical improvements with the addition of the new Animation Framework, plus new advanced graphics effects like opacity, drop shadows, glow, and filtering. One of the most exciting new features is the ability to create multi-touch applications. Key performance improvements come in the form of a highly optimised, re-written Qt GraphicsView rendering algorithm, a new OpenGL paint engine, WebKit, 2D vector graphic support using OpenVG, and new DirectFB support. Learn more at <http://qt.nokia.com/whatsnew>.

Test your mail server

A new Web service called 'All About Spam' [www.allaboutspam.com/email-server-test/] has been launched that claims to be a one-size-fits-all tool for checking your outgoing mail server to see how the server fares with respect to some of the "best practices" for sending e-mails. The Web service is targeted at sysadmins who have a hard time figuring out why outgoing mails end up being rejected by a destination server, or land up in the spam/junk folder of the recipients mailbox. All you need to do is send an e-mail to test@allaboutspam.com and the service sends you an e-mail with a link to the test report for your server.